FOUNDER–CEO AGREEMENT

PulseDNA, Inc.

Founder & Chief Executive Officer: **Stephanie Joyce**

Effective Date: January 19, 2026
Term: At-will, subject to milestone-based performance and vesting

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1. PURPOSE OF THIS AGREEMENT

This Founder–CEO Agreement ("Agreement") defines the roles, responsibilities, performance expectations, equity participation, intellectual property ownership, confidentiality obligations, and termination conditions applicable to the Chief Executive Officer ("CEO") of PulseDNA, Inc. ("Company").

The purpose of this Agreement is to ensure operational clarity, accountability, and alignment in building and scaling the Company's federated AI infrastructure and business operations, including PulseNEXUS™, PulseTRACE™, and related platform components, as well as strategy, fundraising, team leadership, and go-to-market execution.

This Agreement supersedes and replaces any prior oral or written understandings relating to the CEO role.

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2. ROLE AND RESPONSIBILITIES OF CEO

The CEO agrees to perform the following duties in a professional, timely, and commercially reasonable manner:

- Lead the Company's strategic vision, product direction, and overall business strategy
- Oversee all Company operations, including leadership of the executive team (CTO, COO, and other senior hires)
- Drive fundraising and investor communications, aiming for milestone targets such as a $10M capital raise

- Build and maintain a high-performing, mission-aligned team
- Ensure operational execution to reach milestones, including $1M ARR, five (5) to seven (7) operational sites, and enterprise expansion
- Maintain clear, reproducible documentation of key business decisions, strategies, and investor communications
- Provide weekly written updates to the Board and key stakeholders outlining progress, risks, blockers, and timelines
- Act as the public and media representative of the Company when appropriate
- Follow Company-approved standards for governance, reporting, and operational management

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3. PROFESSIONAL CONDUCT AND STANDARDS

The CEO agrees to maintain professional conduct at all times, including:

- Business-appropriate communication
- Clear separation of personal and professional interactions
- Timely responsiveness (generally within forty-eight (48) hours for operational matters)
- Respectful collaboration with leadership, Board members, and stakeholders
- Strict confidentiality of Company information

Conduct that materially interferes with Company operations, team stability, or investor confidence constitutes grounds for corrective action or termination.

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4. COMPENSATION AND EQUITY

4.1 Founder Equity and Control

As the sole full-time founder, the CEO is allocated **approximately thirty-five percent (35%) of the Company's fully diluted common equity**, reflecting founder control of strategic decisions and voting authority. This allocation is detailed in the Company's cap table.

The CEO retains majority decision-making authority over key strategic, operational, and financial matters, subject to Board approval and applicable law.

4.2 Milestone-Based Equity Adjustments

Additional equity or performance-based adjustments may be issued subject to Board approval, based on the CEO achieving extraordinary Company milestones:

Milestone	% Equity	Requirements	Target
Milestone 1 – $10M Capital Raise	1%–2%	Successfully raise $10M in equity or convertible financing	End of Year 1–2
Milestone 2 – $1M ARR	1%	Achieve $1M Annual Recurring Revenue	End of Year 2
Milestone 3 – Operational Sites	0.5%–1%	Successfully establish five (5) to seven (7) operational sites with SOPs	End of Year 2–3
Milestone 4 – Leadership & Enterprise Expansion	0.5%–1%	Executive team expansion, enterprise partnerships, validated repeatable GTM	End of Year 2–3

Total potential equity after milestone adjustments: up to **37%**

Milestone Timing & Dependency Flexibility

Failure to complete a milestone within thirty (30) days of its target date shall **not, by itself, constitute grounds for forfeiture** if such delay is materially caused by factors outside the

CEO's reasonable control, including but not limited to Company funding status, product readiness, engineering dependencies, sales cycles, customer procurement timelines, regulatory or government contracting timelines, or Board-directed changes in Company priorities.

In such cases, the Board and the CEO shall **in good faith review and adjust milestone timelines** as appropriate. The Board retains discretion to suspend or modify vesting **only in cases of material non-performance, lack of good-faith effort, or failure to make reasonable progress once blocking conditions are resolved**.

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5. PERFORMANCE EXPECTATIONS

The CEO agrees to:

- Execute the Company's strategic vision and operational plan
- Maintain oversight of CTO and COO milestone delivery
- Regularly report to the Board on Company performance and risks
- Make commercially reasonable efforts to ensure fundraising, operational, and growth milestones are met

Failure to materially perform these duties may result in corrective action as determined by the Board, up to and including termination.

6. UNVESTED EQUITY REVERSION

Upon termination for any reason, all unvested equity automatically reverts to the Company.

Any repurchase of unvested shares shall occur at the original issue price or the minimum price permitted by law.

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7. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY ASSIGNMENT

All work product created by the COO in connection with the Company, including but not limited to operational processes, documentation, SOPs, and trade secrets, is and shall remain the exclusive property of PulseDNA, Inc.

The COO agrees to:

- Assign all right, title, and interest in such intellectual property to the Company
- Execute any additional documents reasonably necessary to perfect ownership

No intellectual property may be retained, reused, or disclosed following termination.

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8. CONFIDENTIALITY

The COO agrees to maintain strict confidentiality of all Company information, including but not limited to:

- Operational playbooks, SOPs, and processes
- Product roadmaps
- Business plans
- Investor communications
- Customer and government relationships

These obligations survive termination indefinitely.

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9. ACCESS, SECURITY, AND CONTROL

The COO agrees to:

- Use Company-approved operational systems and tools
- Maintain shared administrative access to operational records
- Avoid locking, restricting, or withholding access
- Follow best practices for operational and data security
- Document all processes, deployments, and credentials

All operational assets must remain accessible to the Company at all times.

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10. TERMINATION

The Company may terminate this Agreement and the COO role at any time, with or without cause.

Upon termination:

- Unvested equity reverts to the Company
- Intellectual property remains Company property
- Access credentials must be transferred within seventy-two (72) hours
- The COO must cease representing the Company

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11. MISCELLANEOUS

- Governing Law: State of Delaware
- Amendments: Must be in writing and signed by both parties
- Severability: Invalid provisions do not affect the remainder
- No Guarantee of Employment: This Agreement does not guarantee continued engagement

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12. ACCEPTANCE

By signing below, Stephanie acknowledges that she has read, understood, and voluntarily agreed to the terms of this Agreement.

Founder & Chief Executive Officer
Name: Stephanie Joyce

Signature: ___________________________
Date: ___________________________